

Muhammad Abdulfatah

Indiana Wesleyan University

AIML-500: Machine Learning Fundamentals

Dr. Lola Longe

July 1, 2026

I think humans were created with dignity and purpose and not by a chance, and that the capacity to learn, create, and reason was given, not evolved. Such a conviction lies close to the surface because of what I do. I work with machines designed to simulate human reasoning, instead of making the human mind feel small, it makes it feel more significant. The phrase "fearfully and wonderfully made" is easy to slip past until one devotes time to replicating, even a fraction of that capacity in code and realizes how far the copy falls from the original.

One day, I saw a model draft something so fluently that it shocked me to the core, and on the same day, I saw it state something confidently and entirely wrong about it, without any consciousness that it was incorrect. This gap tells me exactly where the limit of the imitation ends. A machine can imitate thought mechanics, finding patterns, recalling facts, predicting what comes next, and optimizing toward a target. What it cannot imitate is that part of reasoning that bears meaning such as conscience, intention, the weight of a moral choice, and the why underneath the answer. It can describe compassion without feeling it and define justice without being answerable to it.

So I keep returning to one conclusion: the more these tools approach imitation of us, the clearer it becomes that the reasoning they echo comes from a source they may borrow from which they never possess.